

Codebook: soccer_posts.csv

r/soccer Post Data from Arctic Shift Archive | January 1, 2010 – July 31, 2026

Dataset Overview

File	soccer_posts.csv
Records	2,047,322 unique posts
Variables	64 columns
Date range	January 1, 2010 – July 31, 2026
Subreddit	r/soccer
Source	Arctic Shift Reddit Archive (arctic-shift.photon-reddit.com)
Collection date	August 9, 2026
Format	UTF-8 encoded CSV with header row

Data Source Notes

This dataset was collected from the Arctic Shift API, a community-run archive of Reddit data. Arctic Shift preserves the full metadata schema that Reddit generates for each post, including fields that are not visible in the standard Reddit interface. The archive captures post state at the time of retrieval, not at the time of posting — scores, comment counts, and moderation status reflect the values recorded by Arctic Shift's crawler.

Posts were collected in three batches covering January 2010 through July 2026. Duplicate posts (arising from overlap between batches) were removed by post ID. Complex nested fields (e.g., preview images, awards, richtext flairs) are stored as JSON strings within the CSV and can be parsed programmatically.

Variable Definitions

Identification

Variable	Type	Description	Example
<code>id</code>	string	Unique Reddit post identifier (base-36 encoded)	88kf9q
<code>name</code>	string	Reddit fullname (type prefix + id)	t3_88kf9q

Content

Variable	Type	Description	Example
<code>title</code>	string	Post title text	Ray Wilkins: Ex-England cap...
<code>selftext</code>	string	Body text of self-posts (empty for link posts)	(text content or empty)

Author

Variable	Type	Description	Example
<code>author</code>	string	Username of the post author	whistledick
<code>author_fullname</code>	string	Reddit internal user ID (t2_ prefix)	t2_2b02p8l9hv
<code>author_flair_text</code>	string	Author's subreddit flair text	:FC_Porto:
<code>author_flair_css_class</code>	string	CSS class for author flair styling	(CSS class name)
<code>author_flair_background_color</code>	string	Hex color code for author flair background	transparent
<code>author_flair_text_color</code>	string	Author flair text color (dark/light)	dark
<code>author_flair_type</code>	string	Flair rendering type (text or richtext)	richtext
<code>author_flair_richtext</code>	string	JSON array of richtext flair components (emoji, text)	[{"e": "text", "t": "value"}]
<code>author_flair_template_id</code>	string	UUID of the flair template used	a8ad979e-7c07-11e9-...
<code>author_premium</code>	boolean	Whether the author has Reddit Premium	True / False
<code>author_is_blocked</code>	boolean	Whether the author is blocked by the retrieving account	True / False

Post Flair

Variable	Type	Description	Example
<code>link_flair_text</code>	string	Post category flair assigned by moderators	News
<code>link_flair_css_class</code>	string	CSS class for post flair styling	(CSS class name)
<code>link_flair_background_color</code>	string	Hex color for post flair background	#5b5b5b
<code>link_flair_text_color</code>	string	Post flair text color (dark/light)	light
<code>link_flair_type</code>	string	Post flair rendering type (text or richtext)	richtext
<code>link_flair_richtext</code>	string	JSON array of richtext post flair components	[{"e": "emoji", "u": "url"}]

Variable	Type	Description	Example
link_flair_template_id	string	UUID of the post flair template	9beea700-607a-11f1-...

Engagement

Variable	Type	Description	Example
score	integer	Net score (upvotes minus downvotes)	10
ups	integer	Number of upvotes (may be fuzzed by Reddit)	10
downs	integer	Number of downvotes (typically 0 in modern Reddit)	0
upvote_ratio	float	Proportion of votes that are upvotes (0.0 to 1.0)	0.86
num_comments	integer	Number of comments on the post	142
num_crossposts	integer	Number of times the post was crossposted	0
total_awards_received	integer	Total number of awards received	3
gilded	integer	Number of times the post was gilded (gold awards)	0

Timestamps

Variable	Type	Description	Example
created_utc	integer	Unix timestamp of post creation (seconds since epoch)	1522519321
created_datetime	datetime	Human-readable UTC datetime (derived from created_utc)	2018-03-31 18:02:01
edited	boolean/time stamp	False if unedited; Unix timestamp if edited	False or 1522520000

Link & Media

Variable	Type	Description	Example
domain	string	Domain of the linked URL (or self.soccer for self-posts)	i.redd.it
url	string	Full URL of the linked content or self-post	https://i.redd.it/image.jpeg
permalink	string	Relative URL path to the post on Reddit	/r/soccer/comments/88kf9q/...
is_self	boolean	Whether the post is a text/self-post (vs. link post)	True / False
is_video	boolean	Whether the post contains a video	True / False
is_original_content	boolean	Whether the post is marked as original content	True / False
is_reddit_media_domain	boolean	Whether the linked content is hosted on Reddit's media CDN	True / False
post_hint	string	Reddit's content type classification	image, link, rich:video, self
thumbnail	string	URL of the post thumbnail image (or 'default', 'self', 'nsfw')	https://... or default
thumbnail_height	integer	Height of the thumbnail in pixels	140
thumbnail_width	integer	Width of the thumbnail in pixels	140

Moderation & Status

Variable	Type	Description	Example
over_18	boolean	Whether the post is marked as NSFW	True / False
spoiler	boolean	Whether the post is marked as a spoiler	True / False
stickied	boolean	Whether the post is pinned/stickied by moderators	True / False
locked	boolean	Whether comments are locked on the post	True / False
pinned	boolean	Whether the post is pinned to the author's profile	True / False
distinguished	string	Moderator/admin distinction (moderator, admin, or empty)	moderator
contest_mode	boolean	Whether comment scores are hidden and order randomized	True / False
removed_by_category	string	Removal category if post was removed (e.g., moderator, deleted)	moderator
no_follow	boolean	Whether the post has the nofollow attribute (low-quality signal)	True / False

Subreddit

Variable	Type	Description	Example
hide_score	boolean	Whether the score is temporarily hidden	True / False
archived	boolean	Whether the post is archived (no longer accepting votes/comments)	True / False
quarantine	boolean	Whether the post's subreddit is quarantined	True / False
subreddit	string	Subreddit name (without r/ prefix)	soccer
subreddit_id	string	Reddit internal subreddit ID	t5_2qi58
subreddit_subscribers	integer	Number of subreddit subscribers at time of retrieval	8657100
subreddit_type	string	Subreddit visibility type	public

Rich Metadata

Variable	Type	Description	Example
media	string	JSON object with embedded media metadata (video, embed info)	{"reddit_video":{...}}
preview	string	JSON object with image preview URLs and resolutions	{"images":[{...}]}
all_awardings	string	JSON array of award objects with counts and metadata	[{"name":"Gold",...}]
retrieved_on	integer	Unix timestamp when Arctic Shift archived this post	1523411526

Missing Values

Empty cells in the CSV represent missing or inapplicable values. Common reasons include: the field did not exist in earlier versions of the Reddit API (e.g., `author_fullname` was introduced after 2017); the post was deleted before archival; or the field is only populated for certain post types (e.g., `post_hint` is absent for self-posts). Boolean fields use string representations ("True"/"False") rather than native boolean types.

JSON Fields

Four columns contain serialized JSON strings: `media`, `preview`, `all_awardings`, and `richtext` flair fields (`author_flair_richtext`, `link_flair_richtext`). In R, these can be parsed with `jsonlite::fromJSON()`. In Python, use `json.loads()`. These fields are empty strings when no data is available.

Citation

If using this dataset, please cite the Arctic Shift project as the data source: Arctic Shift Reddit Archive, available at <https://arctic-shift.photon-reddit.com/>. The dataset was assembled for academic research at McGill University.